2A Doctor, doctor!

Never go to a doctor whose office plants have died.
Erma Bombeck, American journalist

G present perfect simple and continuous | **V** illnesses and injuries | **P** /ʃ/, /dʒ/, /tʃ/, and /k/

1 VOCABULARY illnesses and injuries

a Do the first-aid quiz with a partner. As you read the options, try to work out the meaning of the highlighted words and phrases.

b **C Communication** Medical myths or first-aid facts? **A** p.106 **B** p.111 Check your answers to the quiz and explain the reasons to your partner.

c **V** p.152 **Vocabulary Bank** Illnesses and injuries

d What illnesses or injuries might you get if you are...?

eating out	hiking in the mountains
doing sport	visiting a tropical country

MEDICAL MYTHS OR FIRST-AID FACTS?

First aid can help treat a minor injury, or even save a life in a medical emergency. However, it's important to know what NOT to do. Sometimes, incorrect first aid can actually be more harmful than helpful. So how useful is the advice you've heard? Do our quiz to find out.

For each question, decide which answers are myths (**M**) and which are facts (**F**).

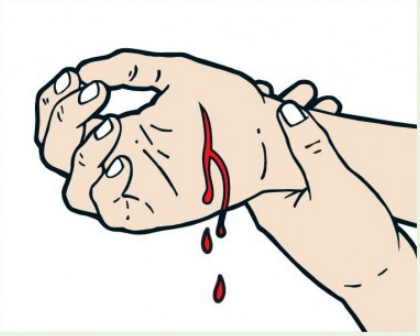
1 What's the first thing you should put on a burn?
- a M butter
- b F cool running water
- c M an ice pack

2 How should you treat a sprained ankle?
- a M put a hot, damp cloth on the ankle
- b F put an ice pack on the ankle
- c F put the leg up, e.g. on a chair

3 What's the best thing to do for someone with hypothermia?
- a M rub their arms and legs to warm them up
- b M give them a brandy or a hot coffee
- c F cover them in something warm, e.g. a coat or a blanket

4 What's the first thing to do if someone is choking?
- a M stand behind them and press their stomach inwards
- b F make them continue to cough hard
- c F hit them hard on the back

5 What's the best way to stop a nosebleed?
- a F tip your head forwards
- b F pinch the soft part of your nose
- c M tip your head backwards



6 After you have cleaned a bad cut, what should you do...?
- a F put on a bandage
- b F put on antiseptic cream
- c M leave it open to the air

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2 PRONUNCIATION /ʃ/, /dʒ/, /tʃ/, and /k/

1	2	3	4

a How do you pronounce sounds 1–4 in the chart? Write the words from the list in the correct column.

ache allergic bandage choking
emergency infection injury pressure rash
sick stomach temperature unconscious

b 2.5 Listen and check. Practise saying the words.

c Use the words in **a** to answer questions 1–3 about the sound-spelling rules.

1 What ways can you spell the /ʃ/ sound? Which do you think is most common?
2 How do you often pronounce *g* before *i* and *e*?
3 Which two ways can *ch* be pronounced? Which do you think is the more common?

d P p.166–7 Sound Bank Look at the typical spellings for /ʃ/, /dʒ/, /tʃ/, and /k/, and more examples. Practise saying the words.

e 2.6 Look at some more medical words. Are they the same in your language? Which sounds in **a** do they contain? Listen and check.

cholesterol indigestion injection
operation scratch surgeon syringe

3 LISTENING & SPEAKING

a Talk in pairs. What would you do and why?

If you were in the street and saw someone who had a medical problem, what would your immediate reaction be?

a I wouldn't do anything myself, but I would wait to see if someone else was able to help.
b I'd call an ambulance and stay with the person until it came.
c I'd go up to the person and see if I could do any first aid.

b 2.7 You are going to listen to Jane, Daniel, and Alison talking about a time when someone needed first aid. First, listen to some extracts and complete the expressions.

Jane

1 …he didn't have a pulse, so I thought he was probably having a heart attack _____ _____.
2 …he took her to one side to calm her down _____, because obviously she was in shock _____.
3 I kept going until the ambulance _____ _____…

Daniel

4 …an old lady stepped off the pavement in front of me and she tripped and fell _____ _____ into the road.
5 She'd fallen heavily, but she was still _____ conscious…
6 It was obviously an effort for her to sit up, it was very painful…

Alison

7 Then all of a sudden, he stopped walking and _____ _____…
8 Some teenagers in the queue _____ _____ _____…
9 …then they put him on a stretcher and _____ _____ _____.

c 2.8 Now listen to their stories. When the incident happened, did they help? Why (not)?

d Listen again and answer the questions for each story.

1 What was he / she doing when it happened?
2 Who needed first aid? Why?
3 What did he / she do?
4 What happened in the end?
5 How did he / she feel a) during the event, b) after the event?

e Talk in small groups.

Have you ever been in a situation where you had to give first aid? Who to? Where were you? What happened? How did you feel?

Has anyone ever had to give you first aid? Why? Where were you? What happened?

Have you ever received any first-aid training? If no, would you like to? In which jobs should people be given compulsory first-aid training?

What could you do if someone…?

- had a severe allergic reaction
- had a high temperature
- got very bad sunburn
- felt faint and dizzy
- got a big blister on their foot
- got food poisoning
- had an epileptic seizure

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4 GRAMMAR present perfect simple and continuous

a 2.9 Listen to a conversation between a doctor and a patient and answer the questions.

1 What symptoms does the patient have?
2 What does he think might be wrong with him?
3 What does he think he needs?
4 What does the doctor suggest?

b 2.10 Listen to what the doctor and receptionist say after Mr Payne has left. What do they think of him? Do you know the name for someone like this?

c 2.11 Now listen to some extracts from the conversation in **a** and circle the correct form, present perfect simple or continuous. Are there any where you think both options would also be possible?

1 *I haven't been feeling / I haven't felt* well for a few days.
2 *I've been coughing / I've coughed* a lot and I keep getting headaches.
3 What *have you been taking / have you taken* for the headaches?
4 How many tablets *have you been taking / have you taken* today?
5 And *have you taken / have you been taking* your temperature this morning?
6 Yes. *I've been taking it / I've taken it* five or six times already.
7 I think I need a blood test. I *haven't had / haven't been having* one for two months.

d p.134 Grammar Bank 2A

e In pairs, use the prompts to ask and answer the questions. The first question should be present simple and the second should be present perfect simple or continuous.

1 / often *get* colds? How many colds / *have* in the last three months?
2 / *take* any vitamins or supplements? How long / *take* them?
3 / *drink* much water? How many glasses / *drink* today?
4 / *do* any exercise? What? How long / *do* it?
5 / *eat* a lot of fruit and vegetables? How many portions / *have* today?
6 / *walk* to school (or work or university)? How far / *walk* today?
7 How many hours / *sleep* a night? / *sleep* well recently?
8 / *be* allergic to anything? / ever *have* a serious allergic reaction?

5 READING & SPEAKING

a Look at the title of the article on p.19 and read the first paragraph. With a partner, try to complete the definition of a *cyberchondriac*. Do you think the tone of the article is humorous or serious?

cyberchondriac /ˌsaɪbəˈkɒndriæk/ (*noun*) a person who compulsively searches the internet for information about real or imagined symptoms of illnesses

b Now read the whole article. Complete the summary of each paragraph with phrases a–e.

1 When the writer found out that she had a fast heart rate, she b
2 At the hospital, she discovered that she d
3 Since she returned from the hospital, she a
4 It's difficult to know from online information whether a condition e
5 A lot of online medical information c

a has been obsessively checking her symptoms online.
b googled the possible causes.
c isn't very reliable or up to date.
d was suffering from a chest infection and cyberchondria.
e is rare or very common.

c Match the highlighted phrases in the article related to medicine to definitions 1–7.

1 open-heart surgery the medical treatment of a heart problem that involves an operation
2 miracle cures successful treatments for an illness that was thought to be impossible to cure
3 under the weather IDM not feeling very well
4 scare stories exaggerated reports in the news that make people worry
5 worst-case scenarios the most terrible situations that could happen
6 heart rate the speed at which your heart beats
7 life threatening illness an illness which could kill you

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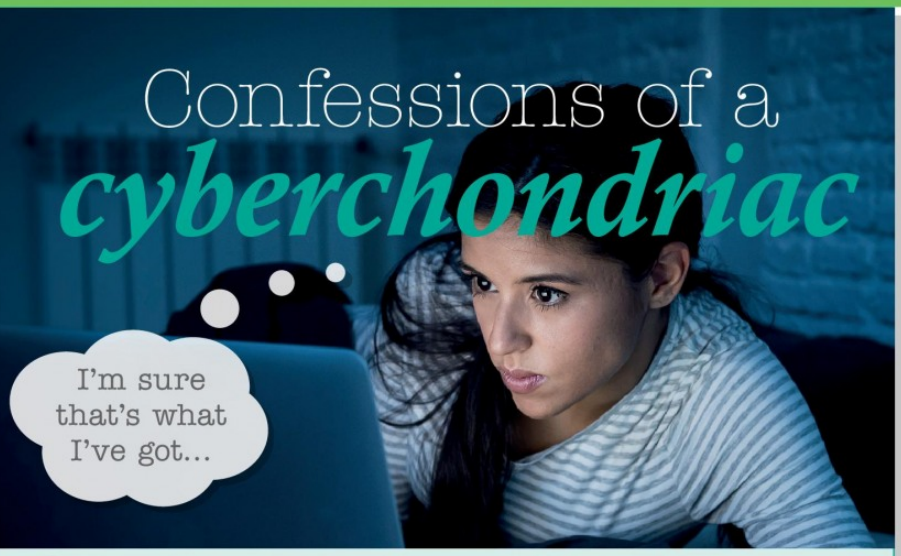
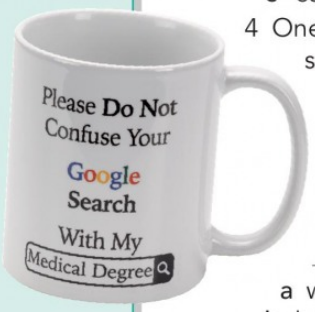


1 **A few weeks ago,** I was feeling under the weather. After days of intensive internet diagnosis, I finally went to see my doctor. After examining me, she told me that my heart rate was a bit fast and sent me off to the hospital for some tests. Did I go straight there? Of course not. First I took out my phone, logged on to Google, and found out that the technical term for a fast heart rate is *supraventricular tachycardia*. Then I typed these two words into Google. Sadly, the problem with Dr Google is that he isn't exactly a comfort in times of crisis. One website immediately scared me with a list of 407 possible causes.



2 I raced to the hospital, convinced that I probably needed open-heart surgery. Four hours later, I got a diagnosis. I had a chest infection…and a bad case of *cyberchondria*. The only consolation for the latter condition is that I'm in good company. A Microsoft survey of one million internet users last year found that 2% of all searches – a not-insignificant number – were health-related.

3 Unfortunately, once you have it, cyberchondria can be hard to cure. Since my trip to hospital, I have been obsessively checking my pulse, swapping symptoms in chat rooms, and reading all about worst-case scenarios. What if the doctors got it wrong? What if the ECG machine was faulty? It's exhausting trying to convince yourself that you might have a life-threatening illness.

4 The Microsoft study also revealed another serious problem – that online information often doesn't discriminate between common and very rare conditions. One in four of all articles thrown up by an internet search for *headache* suggested a brain tumour as a possible cause. Although it is true that this may be the cause, in fact, brain tumours develop in fewer than one in 50,000 people. People also assume that the first answers that come up in searches refer to the most common causes, so if you type in *mouth ulcer* and see that *mouth cancer* has several mentions near the top, you think that it must be very common. However, this is not the case at all.

5 Another problem for cyberchondriacs is that online medical information may be from an unreliable source, or out of date. A recent American study showed that 75% of the people who use the internet to look up information about their health do not check where that information came from, or the date it was created. 'Once something has been put up on the internet, even if it's wrong, it's difficult to remove,' says Sarah Jarvis, a doctor. 'This is a problem, especially with scare stories, and also with some alternative remedies which claim to be miracle cures, but which may actually do you harm.' Check the information? Sorry, I don't have time – I'm off to buy a heart-rate monitor!

Adapted from The Sunday Times

d Now read each paragraph again carefully and choose a, b, or c.

1 The problem with Dr Google is that the information is __b__.
   a insufficient b worrying c false
2 Microsoft's survey discovered that __b__ searches are to do with health.
   a very few
   b quite a lot of
   c the majority of
3 The information the writer has found since coming back from hospital has __a__.
   a made her cyberchondria worse
   b made no difference to her cyberchondria
   c cured her cyberchondria
4 One of the problems with internet searches is that they __a__.
   a don't rank answers in order of probability
   b only focus on common illnesses
   c don't always give an answer
5 Most people are unlikely to check __c__ health information was posted.
   a why and by who
   b how and when
   c when and by who

e In small groups, answer the questions. Ask for and give as much information as possible.

1 Do you know anyone who you think is a hypochondriac or a cyberchondriac? What kinds of things do they do?
2 Do you think people in your country worry a lot about their…?

blood pressure	cholesterol level
digestive system	liver

Give examples if you can. Are there other things related to health that they worry about?

6 WRITING

W p.115 **Writing** An informal email

Write an email to a friend explaining that you haven't been well, and saying what you've been doing recently.

Glossary
ECG machine electrocardiogram machine, used to test people's heart rate

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